The functions `mb_ereg_search_pos()` and `mb_ereg_search_setpos()` allow you to evaluate and manipulate the position of matching. Be warned: this pair of functions counts bytes, not characters, which is admittedly counter-intuitive considering the other `mb_ereg*` functions operate on a multi-byte character basis. Anyway, `mb_ereg_search_pos()` will perform a pattern match, consuming the matching part of the sample in the process, and report back on the position and length of the match. Start again with a newly initialized search:

```
// $text = <<<EOS ...
// Reinitialise
mb_ereg_search_init($text);
// Match and consume 'Demelza: '
mb_ereg_search('^\w+:\s');
// Matches and consumes 'Vằn thắn'
print_r(mb_ereg_search_pos('[^,\r\n]+'));
print_r(mb_ereg_search_getregs());
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => 9
    [1] => 12
)
Array
(
    [0] => Vằn thắn
)
```

The output of `mb_ereg_search_pos()` is an array; the first element is the position (in bytes, *not* characters) of the match, and the second is the length of the match (also in bytes: we captured eight characters, two of them are multi-byte UTF-8, for a total of twelve bytes). `mb_ereg_search_setpos()` takes a single integer argument: the offset from the start of the sample you would like to move the focus to (or from the end of the sample if a negative integer is supplied). If we expand the example above, the position of the sample currently under scrutiny from the regex engine is the newline character(s) after `'Vằn thắn'`.